The Nenthorn Nemesis

2005 New Zealand Rogaining Championships 26 - 27 February 2005

Your team number is

FINAL INSTRUCTIONS TO COMPETITORS.

Please ensure all your team members read this document. It contains important information.

Thank you for your entry in the Nenthorn Nemesis. This information is sent to the team leader only so please copy it to all other members of your team. A copy is also available on the New Zealand Rogaine Association website, http://www.rogaine.org.nz . Attached are Indemnity and Emergency contact forms to be completed by all members of your team and to be handed in at registration. See the website for a list of competitors and up-to-date information.

Acknowledgements

We are indebted to all the landowners who have so willingly allowed us to use their land. Without their cooperation we would not have an event.

We also greatly appreciate the contributions made by the Middlemarch Swimming Club for their catering, Kate Wilson for her enthusiasm and support, and to the many others who have assisted us in so many ways.

Organisers' Contact Details

The organisers may be contacted by telephone or email.

Bob Cunninghame	Ph (03) 473 8330 Dunedin	Email: **signalhill@xtra.co.nz**
Peter Squires	Ph (03) 329-1714 Christchurch	Email: **p.squires@xtra.co.nz**

For **emergency only**, during the event, contact the event centre on 027 2273 019

Directions to the Site

The event headquarters is at "Lindores" Woolshed, about 25 km from Middlemarch. Rogaine direction signs will be in place at some intersections from midday Friday.

(1) From Middlemarch or if approaching on SH87 from the north

At the northern end of Middlemarch turn off SH87 east onto the Moonlight Road (signed Moonlight, Macraes). Follow this road for 3½ km to a Y junction and continue straight ahead onto the Mt. Stoker Road. This is followed for 12 to 13 km to the junction with Summer Hills Road. Go straight ahead along Bray Road to the base area on the left 500m along this road.

(2) From Dunedin/Mosgiel/Outram on SH87

Either travel to Middlemarch and follow the above directions or use the following shorter route to the Mt. Stoker Road. Turn right (east) at Sutton on to Mt. Ross Road and follow this to the junction with Murrays Road 3 km from SH87.Turn left onto Murrays Road and after 3km turn right onto Longford Road. This becomes Mt. Stoker Road after 1½ km. Continue straight ahead and follow Mt. Stoker Road for 10 to 11 km to Summer Hills Road. Go straight ahead along Bray Road and the base area is on the left 500m along this road.

Camping at "Lindores" Woolshed

There are adequate camping sites close to the start-finish area. They are available from Friday through Sunday nights. Please camp only in the area provided, which will be clearly signposted. Water and toilets will be provided. You will need to be completely self-sufficient, including your own Rubbish Bags. Any cooking must be done with gas-fuelled stoves. Note that fires, smoking, dogs, and guns are not permitted anywhere at the Rogaine venue – campsite, administration area, and course.
For alternative accommodation in the Middlemarch area see http://www.middlemarch.co.nz/

Important Note: If you are a competitor **and** the driver of a car please have sufficient sleep before heading home. The campsite is open all Sunday night for this purpose.

Event Timetable

Friday 25th February

4:00 pm	Camping available at the Lindores Woolshed
7:30 pm to 9:00 pm	Registration open

Saturday 26th February

8:00am	Registration opens
9:00am	24hr maps available on presentation of map ticket
9:30am	Novice instruction if required.
11:00am	6hr registration opens and maps available.
11:45am	Compulsory briefing. Ensure you punch your electronic tag here.
12:00pm	24hr mass start
12:45pm	Briefing for 6hr course. Ensure you punch your electronic tag here.
1:00pm	6hr event start
6:00pm	Catering opens at the Lindores woolshed area.
7:00pm	6hr event finishes.
7:30pm	6hr event results announced.

Sunset is at 8:33pm and moonrise is at 9:30pm. The moon will be close to full.

Sunday 27th February

Sunrise is at 7:13am and moonset at 9:56am.

9.00am.	Catering stops
12:00pm	Event finishes
1:15 pm	Lunch Banquet starts – Middlemarch Community Centre.
2:15 pm	Catering closes

Results and Prizegiving will be performed during and/or after the banquet.

Monday 28th February

9:00am	Camping closes

Light food and drinks will be available at the administration area continuously between 6pm Saturday and 9:00 am Sunday.

Map and Course

The map is A3 in size, is pre-marked with the checkpoint positions, and has out-of-bounds areas overprinted. It is vertically oriented to true north, and is based on the standard 1:50,000 topographical series, with 20 m contours. Grid lines 1 km apart show true North and East. There will be one map per competitor. You will need to bring a plastic bag or contact covering as the map is not waterproof. There is NO LEGEND on the map, but one will be posted on the event noticeboard.

The terrain is a mix of farmland and open tussock country with some areas of matagouri. The country ranges from gently rolling to steep, and the streams usually flow in deeply incised beds bounded by low cliffs that may require deviations to cross. There is an area of extensive rock outcrops and elsewhere there are scattered rock outcrops. Altitude ranges from 200m to 600m over the course.

Ponds – in early January, most ponds had water in them, some for the first time in ten years. By early February some were dry again. If a checkpoint is described as a/the pond it will be obvious even if dry. There are numerous unmarked ponds and dams in the area.

Cliffs and Stream Crossing Points – Cliffs are NOT marked consistently over the map. Marked cliffs on the map vary from steep slopes with a few rock outcrops to vertical rock faces up to 20m high. However there are as many unmarked as marked cliffs and some of these are both vertical and high (25-30m). These often make stream crossings difficult as direct access to the stream bed is not necessarily possible and there is considerable scrub (broom and matagouri) in places. Some crossing points will be marked on the map but others will be possible.

Steep and dangerous cliffs have not been marked as too much significant and useful contour detail would have been obscured. All stream crossings should be approached with care and the deeper gorges are best avoided at night. In the streams themselves there are deep pools, but shallow fords are found readily.

Water drops are available on the course and are marked on the map. Please use this water for drinking only and do not waste it.

Remember that in Rogaining there is a distinction between “the” and “a”. For example, “The” watercourse means you can see it marked as a watercourse on the map, whereas “a” watercourse means that one exists, but it isn’t marked on the map.

Safety

All roads are open to the public and you must obey normal road rules and etiquet. In particular, Moonlight Road, on the top and north-west of the map, is a busy public road with traffic on it which won't know about the Rogaine. TAKE EXTREME CARE if you are travelling on Moonlight Road.

There are many bees and beehives around. The exceptionally wet weather has caused a clover boom, and beekeepers from Southland have brought their hives to Middlemarch. So if you are allergic to bee-stings, take your emergency first-aid with you. At all times take care where you sit or stop.

Route Intention map

You will find a black-and-white map of the Rogaine, reduced to A4 size, in your registration pack. After you plan your course, mark it out on this map including the direction you will go and your estimated nightfall and daybreak places. It is a “flight plan” to give the event organisers an indication of where you might be found if a search becomes necessary. You do not have to stick to the route you have specified; it is an indication only. Place the completed map in a box that will be provided at the registration desk. Don’t forget to put your team number on it.

Fences, tracks, and Out-of-Bounds areas

As usual, tracks and fences exist which are not marked on the map, and others are marked but no longer exist. In many cases they serve as useful navigational aids, but you should not assume their accuracy without other supporting information, such as contours.

There are numerous electric fences; some require ingenuity and/or agility to cross. Use your map (in its plastic bag) to hold the wires down while you cross them. Assume all electric fences are on. Note that there are electric fences with hardwood standards and droppers and no insulators – not necessary in a dry climate. The planner noted one fence in the northern section of the map with a live top barbed wire, although the insulators were obvious. Be careful!

Out of Bounds areas

There is one area of deer farm, part of "Gladsmuir", which is marked as out-of-bounds. Note that Gladsmuir Road (private) which passes through this area is also out of bounds. There are locked deer gates on this road.

We do not have permission to use some land and it is important that the owners' wishes are respected. Do NOT attempt to take short cuts across any out-of-bounds land.

Crops

Due to the almost unprecedented rainfall to mid-January, there has been a flurry of ploughing and sowing throughout the area. Please go round the edges of fields of brassicas/turnips, grain, lucerne and standing meadow hay.

Weather and Equipment

This is an exposed area so be prepared for extremes of temperature and wind. Be prepared for temperatures of 35+ in the shade (and there is very little shade!), strong hot desiccating NW winds or cold SW winds with driving squalls of rain or hail. In settled conditions, early morning fog is not uncommon, while frost is another possibility. A weather forecast will be available at the registration area.

A suggested <u>minimum</u> equipment and clothing list is:

Polypropylene or woollen top and trousers.
A heavy waterproof parka.
Gaiters or leggings.
Food.
Water bottle (2 litres minimum).
A whistle each.
A basic first-aid kit for the team,
A large (A3) plastic bag or some clear plastic stick-on covering to protect your map.
A warm hat and mitts.
An extra jersey or fleece top.
Torches, and batteries for 12 hours.
A compass and pencil.
Suitable shoes or boots with a good grip.
A daypack

The northern half of the map in particular is open tussock grassland, up to 600m and exposed to winds from any direction. People going there should carry heavy waterproof parkas, windproof trousers, and a thick thermal top and hat in addition to their normal polypropylene layers. If the weather packs up, you will have to walk into a headwind for several hours to get home, and sleet is a distinct possibility.

If you are in any doubt about the suitability of your equipment, *please* ask an organiser.

You should expect to get wet feet, although you will be able to cover large distances without having to cross streams. There are many small watercourses hidden in the tussock, and there will almost certainly be heavy dew overnight.

Other Gear

You must bring a plate and cup, plus knife, fork, and spoon, for eating at the start-finish area. Bring toilet paper. There will be NO rubbish facilities so you MUST bring your own rubbish bag. A tent and sleeping bag are essential if you think you might stop overnight. Chairs and a table are also useful for planning your route. There will be a limited area available within covered sheepyards and you can use your chairs and tables there if you are early enough; otherwise you should use your tent or car for planning.

Emergency

Blow your whistle (six blasts at one second intervals, repeated every few minutes) to assist any other team to find you. If you have a cell phone, call 027 2273 019. Any team hearing the emergency call must respond and render assistance to the team that is in distress.

Registration and Start Procedure

Your team (one member is adequate) should present a completed Indemnity and Emergency Contact Form at the registration desk. Make sure you have entered your team number on the form. If no money is owing, the team will be issued with checkpoint descriptions, chits for maps, and any last minute course notes. (Any money owing must be paid before map chits will be issued. Correct change would be appreciated). Any changes in team composition must be advised.

At 9am maps will be handed out in return for the chits. Each team must also ensure they pick up a "flight plan" map. Plan your route and complete the "flight plan" map, which must be placed in the box provided at the administration desk.

You must attend the compulsory briefing for all competitors that will be held at 11:45 am. There will be an electronic punch in the briefing area. MAKE SURE you register your tag on this punch. Failure to do so may result in a reduced or cancelled score, at the organiser's discretion.

At 12:00 pm, when the start signal is given, off you go.

If you have never been in a Rogaine before, novice instruction will be available at 9:30 am. Please ask.

Scoring during the Event

There are 87 checkpoints, each numbered between 10 and 105, with a total value of 4450 points.

The checkpoint value is the "tens" value of its number, so for example 37 is worth 30 points, 53 is worth 50 points. Each checkpoint is marked on the map as a 7mm diameter circle, with the checkpoint number beside it.

There is a late penalty of 10 points per minute or part thereof after 12:00 pm Sunday. Disqualification will occur after 12:30 pm which means no score at all.

Electronic punching at checkpoints – insert the punch into the tag as demonstrated in the information page included. A red light next to the checkpoint number will flash. As a backup, you must also read the 2-character blue code inside the punch and write this in the

appropriate square of the waterproof score card included in your registration pack. We suggest that you also write this code on a second piece of paper; perhaps your map.

All team members must visit each checkpoint you claim, to within 20 metres and in sight of it. The checkpoints are marked by a three-sided cloth flag, coloured white and orange. You must not stop at a checkpoint any longer than you need to complete the requirements. If you want to stop for a rest or a discussion, you must move to at least 100 metres away from the checkpoint.

Finish Procedure

At the finish punch your electronic tag and hand it and your score card to the administration staff. Your entire team must finish together; a finish time will be only be recorded when all members are present. The penalty for finishing late is 10 points per minute.

Protests

Reports of breaches of the rules, or protests against the event organisers, will be considered and determined by a three person jury. Such protests must be lodged in writing within 15 minutes of the end of the event. The jury panel for the Championships shall be selected from members of the NZRA committee and NZRA regional contacts, members of the NZOF Rogaining committee, and recognized rogainers. It will exclude the course planner and vetter, who may however be consulted by the jury. The fee for lodging a protest is $20 which will be refunded if judgement is in your favour.

Rules of Competition

The New Zealand Championship will be run under the standard competition rules developed by the Australian Rogaining Association and which are available in full at http://www.rogaine.org.nz/main_files/Ozrules.htm . A copy of the rules will be on the Notice Board at the event.

The following is an outline of some of the important rules:

- The only navigational aids that may be carried on the course are magnetic compasses, watches and copies of the competition map. The possession of other navigational aids, including pedometers, altimeters and GPS receivers on the course is prohibited. The possession of non-competition maps is prohibited at the event venue.
- Members of a team shall remain within unaided verbal contact of one another at all times whilst on the course. A team shall demonstrate compliance with this requirement to any event official or other team on request.
- All team members shall simultaneously approach to within 20 metres, and within sight, of each checkpoint for which points are claimed.
- No fires are to be lit anywhere on the course, this includes the camping area, and the administration area.
- Competitors shall not discard litter or smoke on the course.

The NavLight Punch and Tag system.





We are using a new electronic punching system on this Rogaine. Each team will be given one "Tag" which can be worn like a pendant, hanging from a string around one person's neck. The string will be provided. (In the near future the pendant will be replaced by a Tag rather like a wristwatch, but these won't be ready in time for this event.)

At each checkpoint the person with the Tag must insert the "Punch" into it to record your visit. When punching is completed (about 1 second) a red light flashes. The Punch number is on a label on the outside of the Punch. See the pictures below. There will not be any Intentions sheets to fill in.

Starting and Finishing procedure.

Your team will be given your Tag when you register. Do not lose it. When you attend the briefing just before the start, there will be a punch which you MUST record on your Tag. This is our record that you have started. Without it you may not be scored.

At the finish, there will be another punch, or punches. You MUST insert one of these into your Tag to register your finish time. Failure to do so may mean you incur the late penalty of 10 points per minute before we find you, or complete disqualification. Then hand your Tag to the official on duty.

If you return to the administration area during the event and you intend to go out again, there is no need to punch your tag at the finish. However note that if you change your mind and stay, you will not have a finish time recorded until you DO punch at the finish. There is no harm in punching your tag at the finish and then going out again later; just remember to re-punch when you finally finish.

There will be a sample Punch at registration for you to experiment with. Note that if you re-insert the punch after it has recorded, each flash is a double one. This is OK.

Backup system.

As with any new system which relies on technology, we need a backup. In this case each team will be given a waterproof card, similar to the old Punch Cards used previously, with a square for each checkpoint. You must write the Internal Code for that Punch in the square provided. The Internal Code is a 2-character number written in blue on a piece of paper inside the punch. It can be viewed through the transparent cover. You *MUST* carry a pencil for this.



Punch No. 40 inserted into Tag.



The Internal Code (For backup use.)

TEAM NUMBER: _____

The Nenthorn Nemesis 26th and 27th February 2005

Indemnity and Emergency Contact

Teams will not be registered until the following forms have been completed and presented at the administration desk.

Indemnity

We, the undersigned, hereby acknowledge that the New Zealand Rogaining Association, the Event Organisers, and the owners of the land used for this event, accept no liability for any loss, damage or injury to ourselves resulting from our participation in this event. We enter this event at our own risk and acknowledge that there may be risks associated with the sport of Rogaining.

Name	Signature	Date	Date of birth

Emergency Contact

Your Name and Car Registration Number	Emergency Contact (not a competitor) Name, Address, Phone No.	Allergies or Medical Condition

NOTE:

1. A parent or guardian must sign the indemnity form on behalf of a competitor under the age of 18
2. Supply the name, address and telephone number of a person to contact in the event of an emergency. This person must not be a competitor in the event.
3. Supply details of any medical conditions or allergies that might be of assistance to First Aid staff in the event of an accident or emergency.